

Why I'm skeptical of a Sonoma County Wine Improvement District (op-ed)

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Note: CAUTION: the op-ed's Temecula data-quality claims could not be independently verified against the underlying Temecula reports. Paraphrase only; do not quote as established fact.

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Verified key content

- Argues Temecula's 2019 baseline surveyed only about 19 wineries, and its 2024 data leaned on Dun & Bradstreet modeled estimates for roughly 24 wineries, so the claimed sales increase could be an artifact of estimation.
- Cites Temecula's 2024 report as showing fewer visits and fewer winery-related hotel stays than earlier years.
- Describes a June 2025 Temecula renewal meeting where a board member's question about what ROI success looks like reportedly went unanswered.
- Notes a Sonoma WID would supplement, not replace, existing association dues.